

7.3 MARKING CRITERIA FOR INTERNALLY ASSESSED WORK

Marking Investigations

Marks will be awarded under the following assessment categories linked to the sections of the report:

- I:** Introduction;
- M:** Method;
- R:** Results;
- D:** Discussion;
- P:** Presentation of arguments in terms of quality of written communication.

The relationship between the assessment categories and the mark allocation is as follows:

Assessment Category	I	M	R	D	P	Total
Mark	9	9	8	9	5	40

Marks will be awarded in each **assessment category** for demonstrating the following:

- I:** link between psychological theory and nature of the investigation (AO1);
- M:** use of appropriate psychological methods which could be replicated (AO1, AO2);
- R:** organised presentation of data (AO2);
- D:** analysis and interpretation of information (AO1, AO2);
- P:** presentation and quality of written communication in the report (AO2).

I.1 Inclusion of relevant psychological theory

- | | |
|---|-------|
| No background evidence is presented. | [0] |
| Anecdotal evidence is presented as background to the investigation. | [1-2] |
| The introduction contains some appropriate psychological concepts, theories and/or terminology. | [3-4] |
| Relevant psychological concepts, theories and terminology are presented clearly. | [5-6] |

I.2 Aim and hypothesis

No statement of the aim or hypothesis of the investigation.	[0]
A statement of aim <i>or</i> hypothesis is given.	[1]
Statement of aim <i>and</i> hypothesis is given.	[2]
A clear, concise aim and hypothesis are stated, and are related to the psychology presented in the introduction.	[3]

M.1 Use of appropriate psychological methods

Nature of investigation is not clear.	[0]
Nature of investigation evident from the report.	[1]
Attempts made to state design of investigation and to identify some of the procedures and factors involved in setting up the investigation.	[2]
Design correct. Attempts made to justify it. Section written up correctly identifying procedures, participants, variables, controls. Not enough detail given for method to be capable of replication.	[3-4]
Design correct and justified. Enough details given for method to be capable of replication.	[5-6]

M.2 Ethical collection of information

No application of ethical issues in methodology.	[0]
Candidate demonstrates an awareness of ethical issues in the research.	[1]
Candidate demonstrates an awareness of ethical issues and explains what ethical considerations have been applied.	[2]
Candidate demonstrates an awareness of ethical issues by explaining in detail how they have been correctly applied to the investigation.	[3]

R Organised presentation of data

No findings have been recorded. [0]

Data has been collected and the findings are presented with some degree of clarity. [1-2]

Appropriate descriptive statistics such as means, medians, modes and ranges, graphs and/or tables have been used to summarise the data. [3-4]

Appropriate descriptive statistics, graphs and/or tables have been used to summarise the data. There is a brief statement which highlights the main findings. [5-6]

Data is presented logically in appropriate graphs and/or tables. The findings are well summarised and the main conclusions are clearly evident from the analyses provided. There is a statement which highlights the main findings and which clearly links them to the aims/hypotheses of the investigation. [7-8]

D.1 Drawing inferences from results

No discussion of the findings. [0]

Candidate is able to extract one appropriate conclusion from the reported results. [1]

Candidate can draw inferences from the data, and is able to relate one of these to the aims, hypotheses or background theory. [2-3]

Candidate can draw inferences from the data, and is able to show how these relate to both the aims/hypotheses of the investigation and to the background theory [4-5]

D.2 Recognition of bias and limitations of the investigation

No reference is made to bias or limitations of the investigation, or to any improvements. [0]

Reference is made to one limitation or source of bias in the investigation or to any possible improvements [1-2]

Candidate recognises bias in the information collected and provides an explanation of the way in which this may have affected the results. Suggestions for improvements to the investigation are provided. [3-4]

P Presentation of report and quality of written communication

The report shows no organisation. Poor spelling and a limited range of appropriate technical terms are used.

[0–1]

Candidate has used appropriate sections within the report. Language is clear, with attempts to distinguish relevant material and to assemble a limited argument. Specialist language is used correctly.

[2–3]

The candidate has used the sections of the report appropriately. There is a good quality of expression throughout, with all specialist terms used with a high degree of precision. Very clear written expression.

[4–5]